Reading: Screenagers

💡 **Big idea:** **New media** are forms of media that are **interactive** and let people communicate digitally, like social media, blogs, video games and online news. The article **Screenagers** says teenagers spend a lot of time in front of screens, but the **content and context** of screen use matter more than the hours.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Understand the meaning of new media
- Read an article and decide which statement is not true
- Match words in bold with their meanings
- Give my opinion about screen time

📖 Key words

new media وسائل الإعلام الجديدة	**interactive** تفاعلي	**screenager** مراهق مدمن على الشاشات	**digital native** مواطن رقمي (نشأ مع التقنية)
addicted to مدمن على	**excessive** مفرط	**attention span** مدة التركيز	**consequence** نتيجة / عاقبة
streaming video بث الفيديو المباشر			

What is new media?

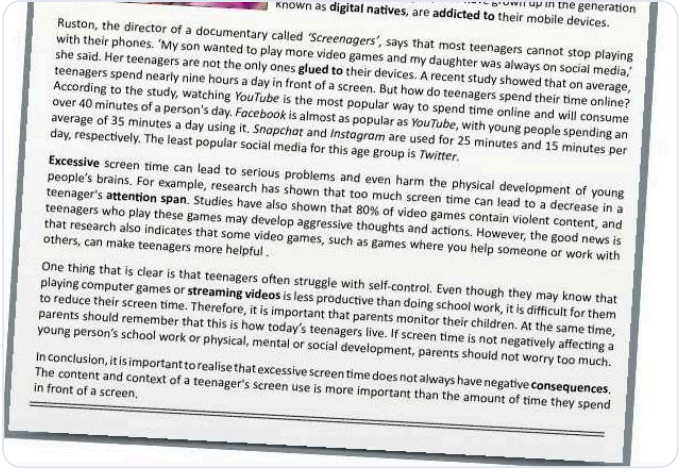
- Media that is **interactive** and digital
- Used on computers, smartphones and tablets
- Includes **social media, blogs, video games** and **online news sites**
- Makes it easier to share our lives and connect with people all over the world

The article Screenagers

- Many teenagers are **glued to** their devices
- Teens spend nearly **nine hours a day** in front of a screen
- **YouTube** is the most popular platform for this age group
- **Excessive** screen time can cause physical problems and shorten the **attention span**

The writer's conclusion

- Some video games are good, like games where you help someone
- Parents should watch the **content**, not only the hours
- Screen time is not always negative
- Content and context are more important than the amount of time



known as **digital natives**, are **addicted to** their mobile devices.

Ruston, the director of a documentary called *'Screenagers'*, says that most teenagers cannot stop playing with their phones. 'My son wanted to play more video games and my daughter was always on social media,' she said. Her teenagers are not the only ones **glued to** their devices. A recent study showed that on average, teenagers spend nearly nine hours a day in front of a screen. But how do teenagers spend their time online? According to the study, watching *YouTube* is the most popular way to spend time online and will consume over 40 minutes of a person's day. *Facebook* is almost as popular as *YouTube*, with young people spending an average of 35 minutes a day using it. *Snapchat* and *Instagram* are used for 25 minutes and 15 minutes per day, respectively. The least popular social media for this age group is *Twitter*.

Excessive screen time can lead to serious problems and even harm the physical development of young people's brains. For example, research has shown that too much screen time can lead to a decrease in a teenager's **attention span**. Studies have also shown that 80% of video games contain violent content, and teenagers who play these games may develop aggressive thoughts and actions. However, the good news is that research also indicates that some video games, such as games where you help someone or work with others, can make teenagers more helpful .

One thing that is clear is that teenagers often struggle with self-control. Even though they may know that playing computer games or **streaming videos** is less productive than doing school work, it is difficult for them to reduce their screen time. Therefore, it is important that parents monitor their children. At the same time, parents should remember that this is how today's teenagers live. If screen time is not negatively affecting a young person's school work or physical, mental or social development, parents should not worry too much.

In conclusion, it is important to realise that excessive screen time does not always have negative **consequences**. The content and context of a teenager's screen use is more important than the amount of time they spend in front of a screen.

The article Screenagers

✏️ Examples

What does "digital native" mean?

Answer: A person who was born or grew up with digital technology

Give your opinion: Do teenagers spend too much time on screens?

Answer: In my opinion, yes, because they have less time for sport and family.

Which statement is NOT true according to the article?

Answer: Excessive screen time is negative regardless of content.

⭐ Remember

- To give your opinion use: In my opinion, ... / I think ... / Based on my own experience, I think that ...
- Read the questions first, then scan the article for key words.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ I am addicted on my phone. ✓ I am addicted to my phone.
- ✗ The new media is not interactive. ✓ New media is interactive.

🧩 **Activity:** Imagine a whole day without social media. Write five sentences about how you would feel

✅ Check yourself

1. Name two types of new media
2. Most popular platform for teens?
3. Meaning of excessive?

Answers: (1) social media and blogs , (2) YouTube , (3) more than necessary